Setup | Linkwarden

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tip

Our official Cloud offering is the easiest way to start using Linkwarden and is typically more affordable than renting a VPS.

Plus, your subscription supports both the development and the continuous improvement of the app for everyone!

Alternatively, if you prefer self-hosting Linkwarden, no problem! You still have access to all the core features.

Here you can find everything you need to setup a fully fledged Linkwarden instance on your own server.

Linkwarden runs comfortably on a small VPS or home server:

- **Memory:** 4 GB is a comfortable starting point.
- **CPU:** any 2 core machine. Images are published for both x86-64 and ARM64.
- **Disk:** about 1.5 GB for the image, plus your data.

If you're running on a smaller machine, or want to know where the memory and disk usage actually goes, see Running a Lighter Setup.

Requirements:

- Docker
- Curl
- Nano

```
mkdir linkwarden && cd linkwarden
curl -O https://raw.githubusercontent.com/linkwarden/linkwarden/refs/heads
/main/docker-compose.yml
curl -L https://raw.githubusercontent.com/linkwarden/linkwarden/refs/heads
/main/.env.sample -o ".env"
```

```
nano .env
```

The required environment variables are:

```
NEXTAUTH_URL=http://localhost:3000/api/v1/auth
NEXTAUTH_SECRET=VERY_SENSITIVE_SECRET
```

```
MEILI_MASTER_KEY=VERY_SENSITIVE_MEILI_MASTER_KEY
POSTGRES_PASSWORD=CUSTOM_POSTGRES_PASSWORD
```

The only thing you MUST change here is NEXTAUTH_SECRET, POSTGRES_PASSWORD, and MEILI_MASTER_KEY, they all should be different secret phrases. The phrase should be wrapped in single or double quotes if any special characters are used.

The NEXTAUTH_URL should be changed to your domain name *only if you are hosting it somewhere else*.

In the main folder (where you created the .env file) simply run the following:

```
docker compose up
```

After a few minutes (depending on your internet connection) you can access Linkwarden via http://localhost:3000 (or whichever hostname you deployed Linkwarden on).

Enjoy!

note

The Manual Installation is targeted towards a more technical audience, to take an easier path, go for installation using Docker.

Requirements:

- Git
- Node (20 and up)
- Yarn (with Corepack enabled)
- Postgres (16 and up)
- Nano
- Monolith

```
git clone https://github.com/linkwarden/linkwarden.git
cd linkwarden
```

```
yarn workspaces focus linkwarden @linkwarden/web @linkwarden/worker
```

```
cd linkwarden
cp .env.sample .env
```

```
nano .env
```

The required environment variables are:

```
NEXTAUTH_SECRET=VERY_SENSITIVE_SECRET
NEXTAUTH_URL=http://localhost:3000/api/v1/auth
DATABASE_URL=postgresql://[USERNAME]:[PASSWORD]@localhost:[PORT]/[DATABASE
]
```

The only thing you MUST change here is NEXTAUTH_SECRET and DATABASE_URL.

The NEXTAUTH_URL should be changed to your domain name *only if you are hosting it somewhere else*.

```
yarn prisma:generate
yarn web:build
yarn prisma:deploy
```

If you want to take advantage of the advanced search options, you need to first follow the Meilisearch installation guide to install Meilisearch.

And then add the following environment variable to your .env file:

```
MEILI_HOST=http://localhost:7700
MEILI_MASTER_KEY=VERY_SENSITIVE_MEILI_MASTER_KEY
```

Keep in mind that you need to have Meilisearch running in the background before you start Linkwarden.

```
yarn concurrently:start
```

There are a few common issues that you might encounter when setting up Linkwarden, here are some of them:

Type error: Module "'@prisma/client"' has no exported member...

This error is caused by the @prisma/client package not being installed correctly, to fix it, simply run:

```
yarn prisma:generate
```

[0] upstream image response failed for https://t2.gstatic.com/faviconV2...

[This will no longer appear in newer Linkwarden versions.]

This error is caused by the favicon (the website's logo) not being found, it's really not a big deal, but if you want to fix it, you can set an icon to the links that don't have a favicon, or you can just hide the icons. The favicon is the only part that isn't actually stored and is being fetched from the internet every time you load the page.

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